

National Neighborhood Data Archive (NaNDA): Personal Care Services and Laundromats by Census Tract, United States, 2003-2017



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Overview and Data Dictionary

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Dataset Overview

Description

This dataset contains measures of the number and per capita density of personal care services (such as barber shops, hair and nail salons, and spas) and laundromats per United States census tract from 2003 through 2017.

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Data Sources

The North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) was used to identify organizations of interest. NAICS was developed by the United States Office of Management and Budget and is “the standard used by Federal statistical agencies in classifying business establishments for the purpose of collecting, analyzing, and publishing statistical data related to the U.S. business economy” (United States Census Bureau, 2017).

Establishment data was taken from the National Establishment Time Series (NETS) database, which provides annual records of the US economy for more than 60 million private for-profit and nonprofit establishments and government agencies (Walls & Associates, 2017). This longitudinal data source classifies establishments by NAICS code and provides detailed business microdata and address history. NETS is produced in most years by Walls and Associates using archival establishment data from Dun & Bradstreet. While it currently includes data from 1990 to 2015 and 2017, only data from 2003-2015 and 2017 were used to create this dataset. (NETS data was not produced for 2016.)

Census tracts for establishments were determined using the 2010 TIGER/Line shapefiles produced by the United States Census Bureau (United States Census Bureau, 2010).

Census tract population figures for 2000-2010 were taken from Neighborhood Socioeconomic and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2000-2010 (Clarke & Melendez, 2019). Population figures for 2011-2017 were obtained from Socioeconomic Status and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2008-2017 (Melendez et al., 2020).

Coverage

The dataset contains one observation per census tract per year in the United States, including Puerto Rico and the US Virgin Islands. Other US island territories are excluded.

Methodology

This dataset highlights the concentration of certain types of personal care services—including barber shops, salons, spas, and weight loss centers—and laundromats per census tract in the United States. These businesses, along with more common gathering places (e.g. coffee shops, churches, senior centers), function as common “third places” in the United States (Finlay et al.,

2019). Third places are locations other than home (first place) and work/school (second place) where people gather, spend time, and casually interact with one another; they are social infrastructure vital to civic life (Klinenberg, 2018). Prior research has shown that their presence in a neighborhood fosters social interaction, community building, and individual well-being (Finlay et al., 2018). They can also serve as locations for health promotion and literacy initiatives among minority populations and in high-poverty areas (Baron & Trujillo, 2019, Linnan et al., 2014, Murphy et al., 2017).

Our research team identified the following NAICS codes of interest:

- 812111: barber shops (men's hair stylists).
- 812112: beauty salons (unisex and women's hair stylists).
- 812113: nail salons.
- 812191: diet and weight loss centers.
- 812199: other personal care services, which include spas, saunas, massage parlors, tattoo parlors, and tanning stations.
- 812310: coin-operated laundries and dry cleaners (laundromats).

For each NAICS code we identified, we queried the NETS database for all establishments that were open at some time between 2003 and 2015 and in 2017 (NETS does not contain data for 2016), and their location during each year. Note that NETS data were not cleaned or verified during this process, and that NETS data has limitations and inaccuracies as described in Gomez-Lopez et al. (2017) and Finlay et al. (2019).

We determined each establishment's census tract for each year by mapping its latitude and longitude provided in the NETS database to the 2010 version of the TIGER/Line shapefiles from the US Census Bureau.

Using these locations, we created three variables to represent establishment counts per tract. The first count variable is the total of all establishments with that NAICS code in the tract. The second is the count of just establishments with non-zero sales figures in the current year, which can be used where desired to filter out establishments with very low business volume. The third is the count of establishments employing more than one person, which can be used to filter out very small owner-operated businesses if desired. The most useful variable for a given research question may vary by establishment type, so we have created three count types for all NAICS codes so that users may make their own decision about the version that best meets their needs.

We then calculated population densities (per 1000 people) for each of the three count variables for each NAICS code. Tract populations for 2003-2009 come from the NaNDA dataset [Neighborhood Socioeconomic and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2000-2010](#). Values for each year are interpolated. For 2010-2012 and 2013-2017, we used the tract population from the NaNDA dataset [Socioeconomic Status and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2008-2017](#). Population figures in this dataset were taken from the 2012 and 2017 ACS five-year estimates, respectively, in order to avoid overlapping ACS estimates as advised by the Census Bureau, and for compatibility with other

NaNDA datasets. Population figures for 2010-2017 are not interpolated. Consult the codebooks for the NaNDA datasets Neighborhood Socioeconomic and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2000-2010 (Clarke & Melendez, 2019) and Socioeconomic Status and Demographic Characteristics of Census Tracts, United States, 2008-2017 (Melendez et al., 2020) for details on why these population figures were selected and how 2003-2009 population was interpolated.

We also created three variables representing the density of establishments per square mile. The area is the land area of the tract from the 2010 version of the TIGER/Line shapefiles. As a result, all area densities are standardized to 2010 census geography and are comparable across years across the entire dataset.

Population density was set to -1 for tracts with zero population in a given year. Population and area densities are missing for tracts in Puerto Rico and the US Virgin Islands, which are not included in the TIGER/Line shapefiles. Population and area densities are also missing in certain years for a few census tracts whose FIPS codes changed at some point between 2003 and 2017.

Finally, we merged counts and densities of all selected NAICS codes to create an aggregate dataset containing tract population, area, and count and density variables for all personal care services and laundromats per tract in each year.

Usage Note

Data users interested in third places and community resources might find further useful data in these additional NaNDA datasets might find further useful data in these additional NaNDA datasets:

- [Arts, entertainment, and recreation organizations by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020a), which includes gyms, libraries, and arcades, among others.
- [Eating and drinking places by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Esposito et al., 2020), which includes coffee shops, fast food restaurants, and bars.
- [Grocery stores by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020b), which includes warehouse clubs.
- [Post offices and banks by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020c).
- [Religious, civic, and social organizations by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020d).
- [Retail establishments by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020e).
- [Social services by census tract, United States, 2003-2017](#) (Finlay et al., 2020f), which includes senior centers.

Variables

For additional information on the definition of each NAICS code, see the Methodology section of this document and the 2017 NAICS website: <https://www.census.gov/cgi-bin/sssd/naics/naicsrch?chart=2017>.

Variable	Type	Obs	Unique	Mean	Min	Max	Label
tract_fips10	string	1036462	74033	.	.	.	Census tract FIPS code (2010 TIGER/Line shapefiles)
year	int	1036462	14	2009.571	2003	2017	Year
population	float	1020881	250271	4208.894	0	65528	Tract population
aland10	float	1022434	72534	48.07265	0	85425.73	Tract land area, square miles
count_812111	int	1036462	25	0.675992	0	25	# barber shops
count_sales_812111	int	1036462	25	0.6315987	0	25	# barber shops w/ sales>0
count_emp_812111	int	1036462	19	0.391915	0	19	# barber shops w/ 2+ employees
popden_812111	float	1015151	152760	31.09827	-1	1.17E+07	# barber shops per 1000 people
popden_sales_812111	float	1015142	146991	31.06969	-1	1.17E+07	# barber shops per 1000 people w/ sales>0
popden_emp_812111	float	1015108	109359	21.50983	-1	1.17E+07	# barber shops per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812111	float	1017996	73467	1.125472	0	268.7466	# barber shops per sq mile
aden_sales_812111	float	1017996	71864	1.04075	0	268.7466	# barber shops per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812111	float	1017996	57389	0.6885337	0	268.7466	# barber shops per sq mile w/ 2+ employees
count_812112	int	1036462	141	4.716594	0	181	# beauty salons
count_sales_812112	int	1036462	121	4.352518	0	170	# beauty salons w/ sales>0
count_emp_812112	int	1036462	95	3.041134	0	132	# beauty salons w/ 2+ employees
popden_812112	float	1015511	361868	33.32525	-1	1.17E+07	# beauty salons per 1000 people
popden_sales_812112	float	1015487	353063	32.99986	-1	1.17E+07	# beauty salons per 1000 people w/ sales>0
popden_emp_812112	float	1015419	309372	32.75496	-1	1.17E+07	# beauty salons per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812112	float	1017996	292064	6.693071	0	1312.099	# beauty salons per sq mile
aden_sales_812112	float	1017996	285379	6.145752	0	1217.411	# beauty salons per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812112	float	1017996	250720	4.479826	0	946.8754	# beauty salons per sq mile w/ 2+ employees
count_812113	int	1036462	21	0.7409206	0	20	# nail salons

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Variable	Type	Obs	Unique	Mean	Min	Max	Label
count_sales_812113	int	1036462	21	0.6790331	0	20	# nail salons w/ sales>0
count_emp_812113	int	1036462	17	0.5308569	0	16	# nail salons w/ 2+ employees
popden_812113	float	1015175	149298	0.2132341	-1	5864.635	# nail salons per 1000 people
popden_sales_812113	float	1015169	141275	0.195997	-1	5864.635	# nail salons per 1000 people w/ sales>0
popden_emp_812113	float	1015141	124336	0.1549634	-1	5864.635	# nail salons per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812113	float	1017996	78568	1.105349	0	230.8943	# nail salons per sq mile
aden_sales_812113	float	1017996	77225	1.01283	0	230.8943	# nail salons per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812113	float	1017996	69020	0.7979881	0	230.8943	# nail salons per sq mile w/ 2+ employees
count_812191	int	1036462	7	0.0489405	0	6	# weight loss centers
count_sales_812191	int	1036462	6	0.044294	0	5	# weight loss centers w/ sales>0
count_emp_812191	int	1036462	6	0.0322376	0	6	# weight loss centers w/ 2+ employees
popden_812191	float	1015064	24698	0.019185	-1	763.4285	# weight loss centers per 1000 people
popden_sales_812191	float	1015063	22976	0.0169199	-1	500	# weight loss centers per 1000 people w/ sales>0
popden_emp_812191	float	1015058	17481	0.0146557	-1	763.4285	# weight loss centers per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812191	float	1017996	7884	0.0542993	0	54.85985	# weight loss centers per sq mile
aden_sales_812191	float	1017996	7812	0.0493702	0	54.85985	# weight loss centers per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812191	float	1017996	6815	0.0350986	0	49.82759	# weight loss centers per sq mile w/ 2+ employees
count_812199	int	1036462	35	0.9490594	0	46	# other personal care services
count_sales_812199	int	1036462	35	0.8567386	0	44	# other personal care services w/ sales>0
count_emp_812199	int	1036462	23	0.5230129	0	27	# other personal care services w/ 2+ employees
popden_812199	float	1015227	177922	0.602519	-1	119069	# other personal care services per 1000 people
popden_sales_812199	float	1015217	167591	0.5373433	-1	119069	# other personal care services per 1000 people w/ sales>0
popden_emp_812199	float	1015169	122459	0.2090846	-1	29767.25	# other personal care services per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812199	float	1017996	105714	1.059374	0	325.6372	# other personal care services per sq mile
aden_sales_812199	float	1017996	102878	0.9566637	0	325.6372	# other personal care services per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812199	float	1017996	82824	0.5793056	0	232.5929	# other personal care services per sq mile w/ 2+ employees
count_812310	int	1036462	13	0.320855	0	18	# laundromats
count_sales_812310	int	1036462	13	0.2995276	0	18	# laundromats w/ sales>0
count_emp_812310	int	1036462	13	0.2804251	0	18	# laundromats w/ 2+ employees
popden_812310	float	1015108	97940	0.0955099	-1	1526.857	# laundromats per 1000 people
popden_sales_812310	float	1015103	93903	0.089297	-1	1526.857	# laundromats per 1000 people w/ sales>0

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Variable	Type	Obs	Unique	Mean	Min	Max	Label
popden_emp_812310	float	1015106	88690	0.0849544	-1	1526.857	# laundromats per 1000 people w/ 2+ employees
aden_812310	float	1017996	40055	0.8021589	0	203.0938	# laundromats per sq mile
aden_sales_812310	float	1017996	39352	0.7436774	0	203.0938	# laundromats per sq mile w/ sales>0
aden_emp_812310	float	1017996	37181	0.7151393	0	203.0938	# laundromats per sq mile w/ 2+ employees

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